

# Emerald Fennell: The Greatest Love Story of All Time [B2]

Emerald Fennell ha scelto Margot Robbie e Jacob Elordi per interpretare Cathy e Heathcliff nel suo (atipico) romance in uscita a San Valentino.

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Emerald Fennell's [breakthrough](#) as a writer and director came in 2023 with the film *Saltburn*, which was one of the most streamed films of that year. Australian actress and producer Margot Robbie and fellow [countryman](#) Jacob Elordi were both involved with that project too: Robbie as a producer and Elordi playing a leading role as the aristocratic Felix Catten. *Saltburn* is a black comedy thriller that tells the story of a working-class Oxford University student who is invited to spend the summer with the family of [fellow student](#) Felix Catten. The film contains graphic scenes of sex, drugs, suicide, and poisoning. So, it should be no surprise that there's plenty of graphic sex and violence (sometimes both together) in Fennell's adaptation of *Wuthering Heights*.

## BLACK OR WHITE?

These graphic scenes in this 2026 version of *Wuthering Heights* are not the only thing to have caused controversy. The casting of Elordi (a white actor) in the role of Heathcliff has [sparked some criticism](#). In Emily Brontë's original text, Heathcliff is described as "a dark-skinned [gypsy](#)." Andrea Arnold, in her 2011 film adaptation, casts black actors as Heathcliff (child and adult.) But according to Fennell, when she first read the book as a fourteen-year-old, she imagined Heathcliff just as Elordi [portrays](#) him. Throughout the history of *Wuthering Heights* adaptations, there have been more white actors playing Heathcliff (Laurence Olivier, Richard Burton, Ralph Fiennes, and Tom Hardy among them) than of any other ethnicity.

## ALLURING

There was some criticism too of the decision to cast thirty-five-year-old Robbie as Cathy. In the novel, Cathy is only in her [late teens](#) when Heathcliff returns to Wuthering Heights having made his fortune. But, given that the style of Fennell's adaptation [calls for](#) an [overtly](#) sexy and classically attractive Cathy, the casting does make sense. Interestingly, the Barbie film was another context in which Fennell and Robbie worked together, with Fennell playing the pregnant Mattel doll, Midge. Entertainment

Land of Screen Dreams: Barbie La musa del cinema indie Greta Gerwig ci sorprende con questa megaproduzione sulla famosa bambola di lattice. Con un cast pieno di grandi attori, il film riflette sia la polemica generazionale sia il successivo impulso progressista che ha garantito la popolarità della Barbie negli ultimi sei decenni. Alex Phillips, Molly Malcolm

## CHAINS OF LOVE

The soundtrack to Wuthering Heights 2026, composed mainly by Australian composer Anthony Willis, does a great job capturing the atmosphere of the wild and windy [moors](#). To complement this, British singer-songwriter Charli XCX has written an entire concept album of original songs inspired by the screenplay and [released](#) to coincide with the Valentine's Day launch. These include House featuring John Cale of The Velvet Underground and Chains of Love, a song that includes the [lines](#): "The chains of love are cruel" and "I know the chains of love won't break." Anyone who has read Emily Brontë's novel will know themes of sexual violence and sadomasochism are never far from the surface. While some might criticise Fennell's approach as exaggerated, she's only [shining a light on](#) themes that were always present in what she calls "the greatest love story of all time." If you want to know more about this topic, read the articles Top 5 Wuthering Heights Adaptations and Emily Brontë's Wuthering Heights.

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# Glossary

- **breakthrough** = svolta
- **countryman** = connazionale
- **sparked some criticism** = suscitare critiche
- **gypsy** = zingaro
- **late teens** = ultimi anni dell'adolescenza
- **calls for** = richiedere
- **moors** = brughiera
- **lines** = versi
- **fellow student** = compagno di studi
- **portrays** = interpretare
- **overtly** = apertamente
- **released** = lanciare
- **shining a light on** = mettere in luce